AI automation report: course lead generation workflow

Google Forms → Make → Airtable (category routing) → confirmation email

1. Executive summary

This report documents an automation built to capture, sort, and confirm leads for a course/training business offering four programs: AI Automation, Cloud Computing and Others, Cyber Security, and Web Development. The workflow removes manual sorting of incoming leads by course interest and guarantees every lead receives an immediate confirmation email — no lead sits unacknowledged, and no team member has to manually read through a spreadsheet to work out who signed up for what.

The pipeline has four stages:

1. Google Forms — lead capture
2. Make — automation engine (trigger + routing)
3. Airtable — data storage, split by course category into separate tables in one base
4. Confirmation email — sent automatically to every lead, regardless of category

This is a working piece of marketing-operations infrastructure: it converts an ad-hoc “check the spreadsheet” process into a self-sorting, self-confirming system.

2. What was built

2.1 Lead capture — Google Forms

A Google Form is the single entry point for all leads. It collects the standard fields (name, email, phone, and — critically — a course-category selector with the four options: AI Automation, Cloud Computing and Others, Cyber Security, Web Development). The category field is the value the router downstream keys off of, so the form is the source of truth for classification rather than any manual tagging later in the pipeline.

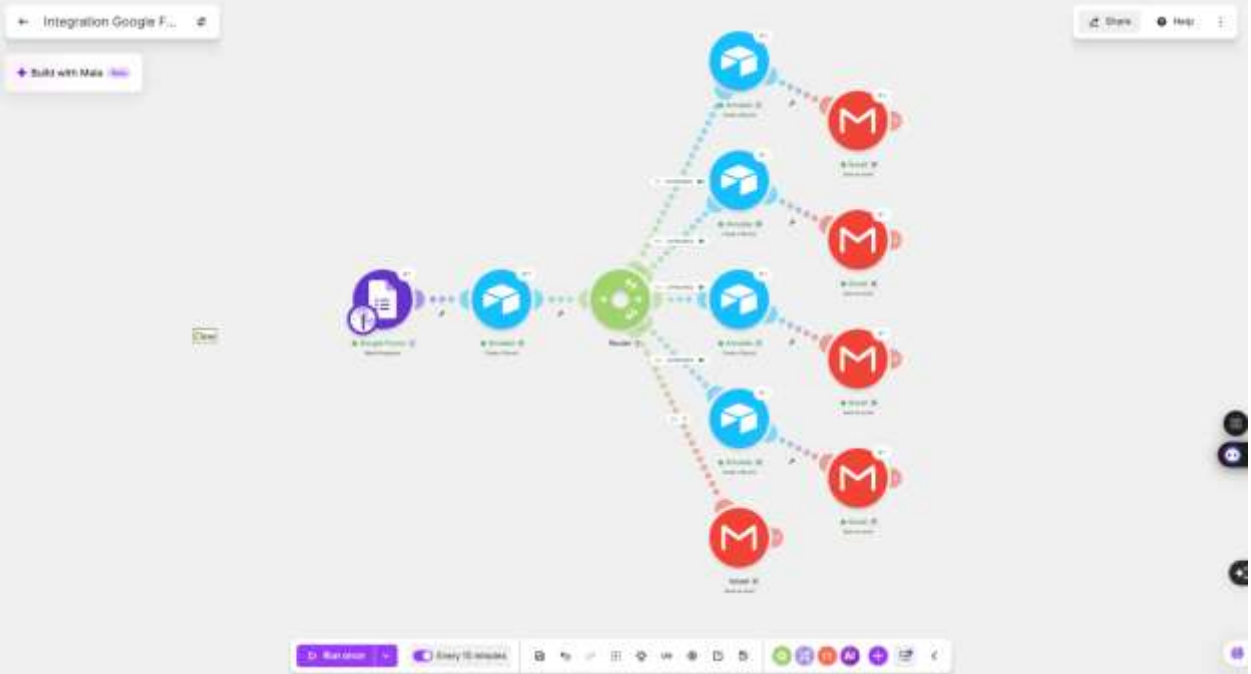


2.2 Automation engine — Make

Make sits between the form and Airtable and does two jobs:

- Trigger: watches the Google Form (via the native Google Forms module, which polls for new responses) and fires a scenario run for every new submission.
- Router: reads the course-category value from that submission and directs the record down one of four paths, one per category, so each lead is written to the matching table without any manual review.

This is a clean two-purpose scenario — capture, then classify — which keeps it easy to maintain: if a fifth course category is added later, it's one new form option plus one new router branch, nothing else changes.

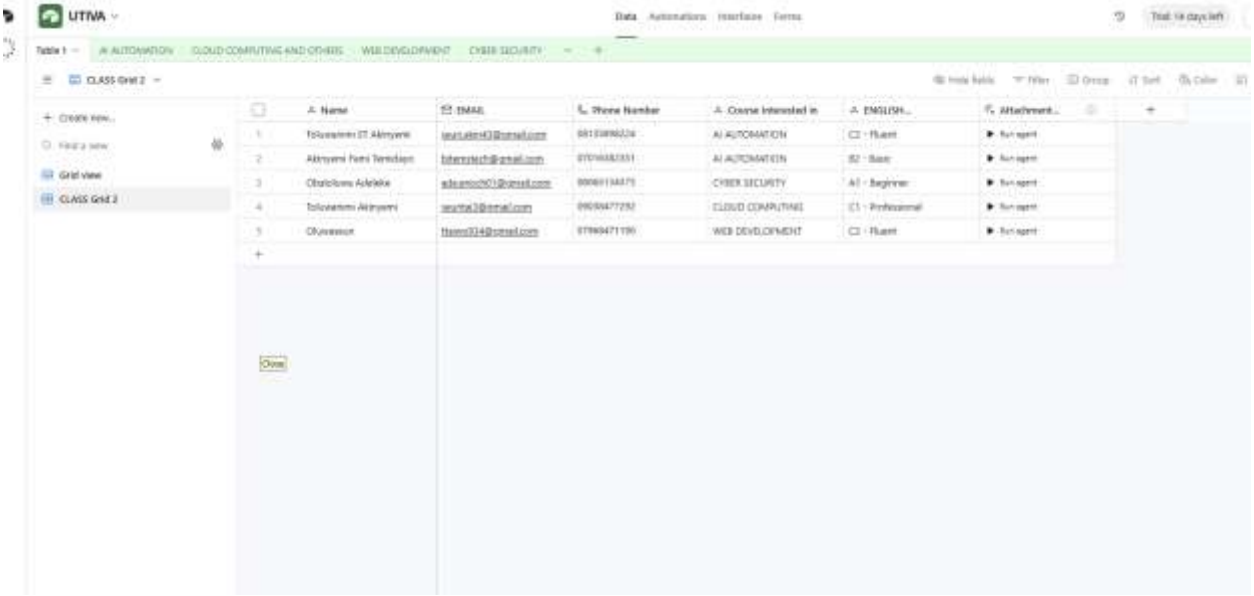


2.3 Storage and segmentation — Airtable

All four category tables live inside the same Airtable base, which was the right call here: it keeps every course's leads in one shared workspace (shared permissions, one place to open, one place to back up) while still giving each course its own clean table rather than one giant table filtered by a category column. The router's job is exactly this: take the single incoming Airtable write and send it to the correct table:

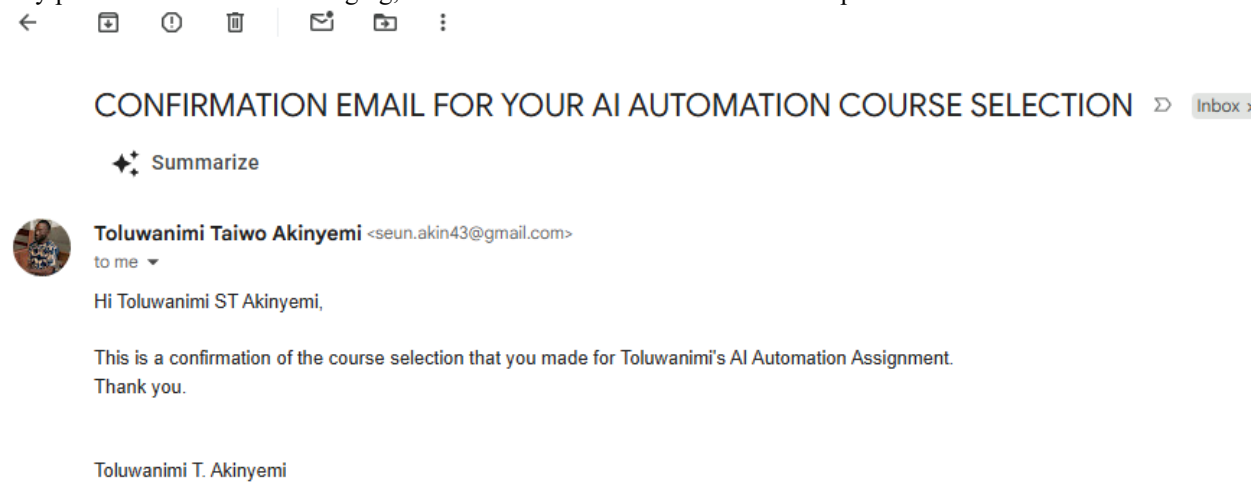
- AI Automation
- Cloud Computing and Others
- Cyber Security
- Web Development

Each table can now carry course-specific fields if needed later (e.g., a “preferred cohort start date” field that only makes sense for one course) without cluttering the others — something a single filtered table can't do as cleanly.



2.4 Lead acknowledgment — confirmation email

After the Airtable write, a confirmation email is sent to the lead. Because this step follows all four router branches rather than being duplicated inside each one, every lead gets the same acknowledgment regardless of which course they picked — consistent messaging, no branch left without a confirmation step.



3. Data flow, end to end

1. A prospective student fills out the Google Form and selects a course category.
2. Make's Google Forms trigger picks up the new response.
3. Make's router reads the category field and evaluates it against four match conditions (one per course).
4. The matching branch writes the lead's data into the corresponding Airtable table within the same base.
5. Once the record is written, Make sends the lead a confirmation email acknowledging their submission.

The result: a lead who submits the form sees a confirmation in their inbox within moments, and by the time anyone on the team checks Airtable, the lead is already sitting in the correct, course-specific table — no sorting required.

4. Why this design works

Design choice	Why it's effective
Google Forms as the single intake point	One familiar, no-cost tool for prospects; no custom form-building needed
Router keyed on the form's category field	Classification happens automatically and consistently — no human judgment call, no missed leads
Separate tables per course, same base	Clean per-course views for whoever manages each program, without losing the convenience of one shared file
Confirmation email after all branches converge	Guarantees identical, reliable acknowledgment regardless of which course was picked

This mirrors the same core pattern from the general lead-automation framework — capture, normalize/classify, store, act — applied specifically to a course-enrollment use case where “classify” means “which course” rather than “how qualified.”

5. Marketing and operational impact

- Zero manual sorting — previously, someone would have had to open a spreadsheet and tag each row by course; now that happens at submission time.
- Faster lead response — the confirmation email is instant, which matters for course enrollment where prospects are often comparing several training providers at once.
- Clean per-course reporting — because each course has its own table, conversion rates, volume, and follow-up status can be tracked per program without extra filtering work.
- Low maintenance overhead — the whole system is two tools (Make + Airtable) and one router with four branches; nothing here requires ongoing engineering support.